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To: Michael Jackson

From: Shawn Jodway, Student # 71113013

Peace Pipe Project
(Aboriginal and Treaty Rights Class)

*From the red stone of the quarry
With his hand he broke a fragment,
Moulded it into a pipe-head,
Shaped and fashioned it with figures;
From the margin of the river
Took a long reed for a pipe-stem,
With its dark green leaves upon it;
Filled the pipe with bark of willow,
With the bark of the red willow;
Breathed upon the neighboring forest,
Made its great boughs chafe together,
Till in flame they burst and kindled;
And erect upon the mountains,
Gitche Manito, the mighty,
Smoked the calumet, the Peace-Pipe,
As a signal to the nations.*

From "The Song of Hiawatha"
Henry Wadsworth Longfellow

I choose to build a clay peace pipe because of its significance in treaty negotiations between Aboriginals and non-Aboriginals. Peace pipes have a long and symbolic history in the relations between Aboriginal non-Aboriginals. This paper will briefly describe this significance, the process I followed in building the peace pipe, and the significance of its symbolic design.

When Aboriginal Nations dominated North America, carrying a ceremonial pipe signified peaceful intent. The first European to arrive in North America carried pipes in case of chance meetings with Aboriginals because treaties with non-Aboriginals were often 'sealed' by smoking a ceremonial pipe. The term "peace pipe" came from the idea that smoking the pipe during the signing of a peace treaty signified peace and friendship.

Aboriginals have used peace pipe for many other ceremonies besides making treaties.

In combination with tobacco and other plants, peace pipes have been used for medicinal and religious purposes because tobacco is highly regarded as the one of the most sacred plants to many Aboriginal peoples. Aboriginals have used tobacco to show reverence for their Creator, and respect for each other. Tobacco is used in daily offerings and libations such as sprinkling tobacco to ask for strength or a safe journey to or from home. Today the peace pipe is used for even more types of events. Not only are pipes used for religious ceremonies they are also used to 'witness' an event, such as the swearing in of an elected official, naming ceremonies for children, and groundbreaking for new buildings and facilities. Aboriginals believe that the rising smoke from the pipe carries messages to their Creator.

Building the pipe



I used red clay to build the pipe because it was the most commonly used clay to build pipes by Aboriginals. First I “threw” the bowl portion on a potters wheel, and then I hand-built the stem section by using a piece of

guide.

After the pieces were slightly drier I trimmed them to fit better and joined them together using slip, which is glue for clay.



(Painting on the slip)

After the two pieces were connected I put holes in the bowl and one on the end of the



pipe for draft control.

The final stage was trimming and carving in a pattern. I choose to carve the

Metis symbol on the pipe's bowl because I self identify as a Metis as my father's mother was Cree from the James Bay region. My family name was originally spelled "Joudion" but when my father was sent to a residential school in St. Albert, the priest 'Anglicized' it for him so it is was spelled "Jodway" so the priest could pronounce it easier.



Once I finished assembling the pipe I put it in a 'bisque' kiln for the first firing at 1800 degrees. After that was completed I prepared the pipe for the second and final firing at 2200 degrees by painting on a red iron oxide to make it look more authentic. I also dipped the two ends in a 'black pearl' glaze (a black coloured dye). The clay pipe was fired twice because the clay and glaze dry at an uneven rate, so the first firing is to dry the clay to the point where the glaze and clay could fire consistently together during the second firing.

The final stage of the pipe building occurred after it was finished the second firing. I put a bracelet of blue and yellow beads around the pipe to represent the colours of UBC sports teams. There is also an Abalone shell on the bracelet, which just happen to be there when I bought it from an Aboriginal vendor on the Seawall (near Second beach). Sea and river shells are a common adornment of pipes so the Abalone shell is not out of place. Finally a leather band made from deer hide and dyed green was wrapped around the pipe in a cross hatch pattern to aid in holding the pipe while using it.

I really appreciate the latitude that you extended to our class in encouraging us to submit non-conventional projects to be graded. I also welcome you to try the pipe out if you feel its' necessary to properly assess and grade it.